Simulated Project Status Report

End of Sprint 2 - Friday 30 January 2026 (Week 4 of 10)

SIMULATED PROJECT - Self-directed portfolio case study. Not professional experience, not client work, not employment. All people, figures and outcomes are fictional.

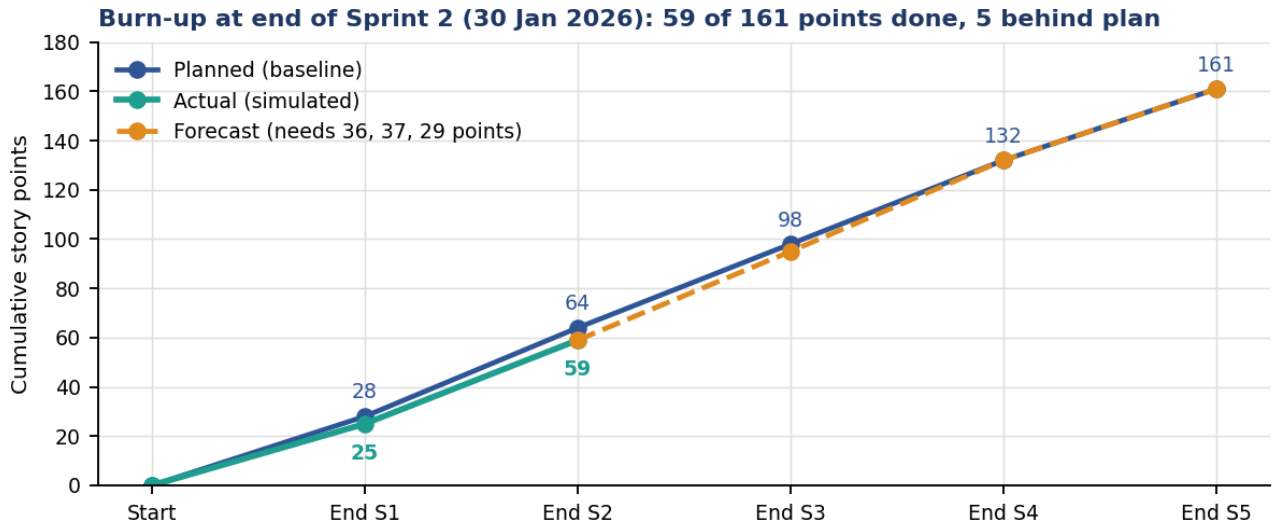
Report	Simulated Project Status Report - Report 2 of the simulated project (end of Sprint 2)
Reporting date	Friday 30 January 2026 (Week 4 of 10)
Period covered	5 Jan - 30 Jan 2026 (Sprints 1 and 2)
Audience	Executive Sponsor, Product Owner, Support Manager, CTO (steering)
Next report	Friday 13 February 2026 (Sprint 3 review)

1. Overall status

Area	Status	Comment
Overall	Amber	Delivery on track for the pilot date, but 5 points behind plan, thin schedule slack and two open decisions.
Schedule	Amber	M1-M3 met on baseline dates; US-05 slipped 2 days in Sprint 1 and US-15 (golden set) carried into Sprint 3.
Scope	Green	No change to Must-Have scope. CR-001 (Spanish) assessed and deferred through change control.
Budget	Green	505 USD spent of 5,500 USD non-labour budget; forecast at completion 4,500 USD before the 500 USD contingency.
Quality / AI	Amber	RAG answers with citations demonstrated at M3; accuracy not yet measured on the full golden set (72 of 100 validated).
Risks / issues	Amber	5 Critical risks open; R03 (content quality) has materialised in part (Issue I-02); provider terms pending (D-01).
Resources	Green	Team allocated as planned; UX capacity ends after Sprint 2 as planned.

Summary

Four weeks in, the project has an approved charter and requirements baseline, working environments, a validated UX prototype, an evidence-based LLM recommendation and a Sprint 2 demo of cited AI answers with safe fallback. Velocity is 25 and 34 points against plans of 28 and 36. The gap is five points (US-15 golden set), and Sprint 3 is forecast at 36 points, which is inside the planning band of 34 points +/- 10%. Three items need attention this fortnight: the LLM provider's data-handling terms, the remaining 17 outdated knowledge-base articles and nominations for UAT participants.



Sprint	Planned	Done	Cum. planned	Cum. actual	Variance	Comment (story points)
Sprint 1	28	25	28	25	-3	US-05 (RBAC, 3 SP) not finished; completed 20 Jan (Issue I-01)
Sprint 2	36	34	64	59	-5	US-05 (3 SP) done; US-15 (5 SP) carried into Sprint 3

2. Completed work

- M1 Charter approved 7 Jan; M2 requirements and UX baseline approved 16 Jan; M3 Sprint 2 demo held 30 Jan (all on baseline dates).
- Stories done: US-01, US-02, US-03, US-04, US-11 (Sprint 1); US-05, US-09, US-10, US-12, US-13, US-14 (Sprint 2).
- LLM and embedding spike: recommendation and fallback model approved 16 Jan by Product Owner and Security & Privacy Officer.
- Knowledge-base audit (WBS 6.3): 320 articles exported; 41 duplicates removed; 52 outdated articles flagged, 35 updated, 17 still open.
- Usability sessions (20-22 Jan, 5 agents): 9 findings logged; 2 severity-1 items fixed in the design handoff on 23 Jan.
- Sprint 2 demo: customers' questions answered with cited sources; out-of-scope and low-confidence questions fall back to an escalation offer.

3. Current work (in progress at report date)

- US-15: golden set at 72 of 100 validated questions; evaluation script runs end-to-end on the Sprint 2 build (QA Engineer, due 4 Feb).
- Provider data-handling review with Legal and Security (Dependency D-01).
- Email sending-domain verification request with IT (D-04).
- Sprint 3 refinement: US-06, US-16, US-18, US-19 and US-25 at Definition of Ready.

4. Upcoming work (next two weeks)

Sprint 3 (2-13 Feb): forecast 36 points	Notes
US-15 golden set (5, carried) | US-06 customer email-code sign-in (5) | US-16 customer chat UI (8) | US-18 conversation history (5) | US-19 escalation request (8) | US-25 PII redaction (5)	US-17 answer feedback (3 SP, Should) proposed to move to Sprint 4 - see Decision D1.
AI evaluation run #1 (baseline) starts 9 Feb; first accuracy and unsupported-answer figures reported at the 13 Feb review.	Gate: accuracy at least 85% and unsupported answers at most 5% (Proposed Project Targets).
M4 customer chat + escalation request demo on 13 Feb.	UAT participant nominations needed by 13 Feb (D-06).

5. Milestones

ID	Milestone	Baseline	Forecast / actual	Status
M1	Project Charter approved	7 Jan 2026	7 Jan 2026	Complete
M2	Requirements & UX baseline approved	16 Jan 2026	16 Jan 2026	Complete
M3	Sprint 2 review: KB ingestion + RAG answers demo	30 Jan 2026	30 Jan 2026	Complete
M4	Sprint 3 review: customer chat + escalation request demo	13 Feb 2026	13 Feb 2026	On track
M5	Feature complete / code freeze	27 Feb 2026	27 Feb 2026	At watch (thin slack)
M6	UAT sign-off	6 Mar 2026	6 Mar 2026	On track
M7	Go / No-Go decision	9 Mar 2026	9 Mar 2026	On track
M8	Pilot release to production	11 Mar 2026	11 Mar 2026	On track
M9	Project closure	13 Mar 2026	13 Mar 2026	On track

6. Risks (top items; full register in 11_Risk_Register.xlsx)

ID	Risk	Score	Trend	Update
R01	AI hallucination: the assistant states something not supported by the knowledge base (for example a wrong billing rule).	20	Stable	Guardrails demonstrated; first formal accuracy measurement due 13 Feb.
R03	Poor knowledge-base content: duplicate, outdated or conflicting articles produce wrong answers.	16	Realised in part	Audit found 41 duplicates, 52 outdated; 17 still open (Issue I-02, due 6 Feb).
R04	Data privacy: personal data is sent to the LLM provider, retained too long, or cannot be deleted on request.	15	Watch	Provider terms not yet confirmed (D-01); only test data in use.
R08	Scope creep: new feature requests (languages, integrations, extra channels) after the baseline.	16	Falling	CR-001 handled through change control without disruption.
R09	Development delays from under-estimation by a new team with no historical velocity.	12	Stable	Velocity 25 then 34; Sprint 3 forecast 36 is within planning band.
R05	Security vulnerabilities: broken access control, injection or prompt injection exposing data or tampering with answers.	15	Stable	Hardening planned Sprint 4; no findings yet.

7. Issues

ID	Issue	Owner	Due	Status
I-01	RBAC story (US-05) not finished in Sprint 1: permission-matrix questions took two extra days to settle.	Backend Developer	20 Jan	Resolved
I-02	17 of the 52 outdated KB articles are still not updated after the audit (Support SMEs short of time).	Product Manager	6 Feb	Open
I-03	Golden set: 72 of 100 questions have validated reference answers; US-15 carried into Sprint 3.	QA Engineer	4 Feb	Open
I-04	Flaky integration test blocked the CI pipeline on 14 Jan.	DevOps Engineer	15 Jan	Resolved
I-05	Staging environment answered the first request slowly (cold start) while preparing the Sprint 2 demo.	DevOps Engineer	29 Jan	Resolved

8. Dependencies needing attention

ID	Dependency	Owner	Needed by	RAG
D-01	Provider data-handling terms (no training on our data, minimal retention) confirmed by Legal and Security	Hannah Weber (Security & Privacy Officer)	6 Feb	Amber
D-03	Cleaned KB export from Support (approx. 280 articles)	Aiden Park (Knowledge & Content Lead)	23 Jan	Amber
D-04	Email sending-domain verification (SPF/DKIM) for OTP and notification emails	DevOps Engineer with IT (DNS owner)	2 Feb	Amber
D-09	Reference answers validated by Support SMEs for the golden set	Elena Rossi (Product Manager)	30 Jan	Amber

9. Decisions required

ID	Decision	Decision maker	Needed by	Recommendation / impact if late
D1	Move US-17 Answer feedback (Should, 3 SP) from Sprint 3 to Sprint 4 to hold Sprint 3 at 36 points.	Product Owner	Mon 2 Feb	Recommend approve. Sprint 4 then forecasts 37 points (within +10% band); dashboard feedback metric is still ready by M5.
D2	Confirm LLM provider data-handling terms in writing (no training on company data, minimal retention).	Security & Privacy Officer with Legal	Fri 6 Feb	Without it, real customer data cannot be used and the pilot is blocked (R04).
D3	Nominate at least 3 agents plus a backup for UAT on 2-6 Mar.	Support Manager	Fri 13 Feb	Late nominations compress UAT and raise R13.
D4	Approve the AI-quality gate: go-live needs accuracy of at least 85% and at most 5% unsupported answers; if missed after evaluation run #2 (27 Feb), choose between a smaller pilot (top 10 categories) or a moved Go/No-Go.	Executive Sponsor	Fri 6 Feb (principle)	Agreeing the rule now avoids a debate at M5 (R01, R15).

10. Budget (non-labour, simulated figures)

Line	Budget (USD)	Spent to date	Forecast at completion
Cloud hosting and monitoring	3,000	410	2,800
LLM and embedding API	1,500	95	1,300
Email service and tooling	500	0	400
Contingency (10%)	500	0	500 (held)
Total	5,500	505	4,500 + 500 contingency held